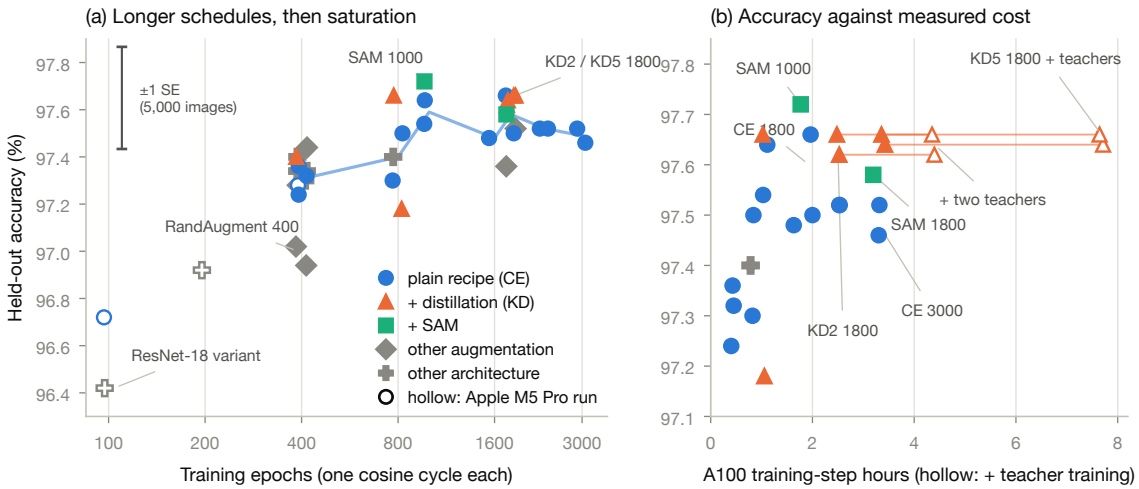
(a) Longer schedules, then saturation
Held-out accuracy (%)
97.8
97.6
97.4
97.2
97.0
96.8
96.6
96.4
±1 SE
(5,000 images)
SAM 1000
KD2 / KD5 1800
RandAugment 400
ResNet-18 variant
plain recipe (CE)
+ distillation (KD)
+ SAM
other augmentation
other architecture
hollow: Apple M5 Pro run
100
200
400
800
1600
3000
Training epochs (one cosine cycle each)
(b) Accuracy against measured cost
97.8
97.7
97.6
97.5
97.4
97.3
97.2
97.1
SAM 1000
KD5 1800 + teachers
CE 1800
+ two teachers
SAM 1800
CE 3000
KD2 1800
0
2
4
6
8
A100 training-step hours (hollow: + teacher training)